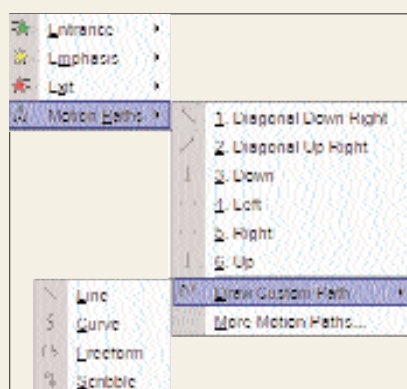


PowerPoint introduces a new menu option to insert diagrams easily into your presentation

dialog box and choose the left-top corner chart. You could right-click any of those boxes to add Subordinates, Co-workers or Assistants to the existing charts. This reduces work when you have to build organisational charts with PowerPoint XP. You can also select Venn diagrams, Cycles, Radials, Pyramids, etc from the Diagram listings.

Customise animations

You can now customise animations in PowerPoint XP. Start off by selecting your own tract for the object to move on. This could either be a straight line, a curve, or a scribble. Right-click the text or the image for which the animation is to be set. The task pane opens and gives



Draw your own animation schemes

you a list of animations that can be assigned to an object on the presentation. To choose your own animation style, click on Add Effect and choose Motion paths. From this, choose the

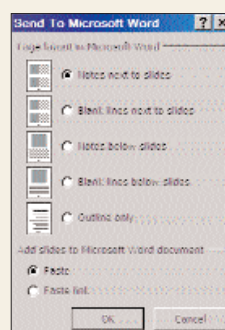
Draw Custom path submenu. This provides you with options to draw Straight lines, Curves or Scribble paths. You can choose any of these options and draw the path on the slide. The starting position would be denoted by a green triangle and the trailing edge by a red triangle. You can also resize and move the path. In this manner, you can even create small cartoon movies using PowerPoint XP.

The print preview option

PowerPoint XP has finally added the print preview facility. You can use this to preview slides before printing. This option was not present in the earlier version.

Creating alternative layouts in Word

You now have the power to create alternative layouts (for making handouts) in Word, which are not available in PowerPoint XP. You can do this by exporting the slide to Word through the Send To option. From the File menu choose the



PowerPoint allows you to export your presentations to Word to make Word style layouts

Send To option, click Microsoft Word and then select a layout option. For example, if you want to print three slides per page but do not want lines for audience notes, send the handout to Word, choose the Blank lines next to the slides option, and delete the lines in Word. Choose any layout that suits your requirement and export the slides to Word. You can also make the necessary additions and deletions to the handouts in Word.

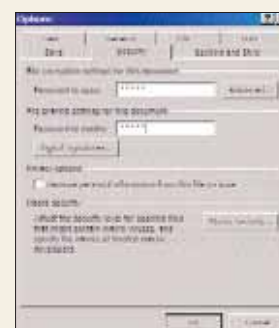
Add a button to the macro

You might be required to use a particular macro many times in a presentation or across presentations. It will be easier for you to create the macro and place it on the standard toolbar for instant access. To do this, choose Customize from the Tools menu. In the window that pops up, choose the Commands tab and click on Macros from the Categories option. The right side of the window will display all the macros available. Click and drag the one you want to access and drop it on the toolbar when you see a plus sign.

Note that the plus sign should appear while you move the macro to the toolbar. If you see a cross sign instead, it implies that the macro cannot be placed in the area you want it to be.

Protecting presentations

Earlier versions of PowerPoint had one major drawback: you could not protect the slides. And the only way you could make them was through PowerPoint show files. Now PowerPoint XP gives you the additional option of protecting your slides by a password. Choose the Options submenu from Tools and click on the Security Tab in the window that pops up. You can select either the Password to Open or the Password to Modify option, or both. Clicking on the Advanced button lets you choose the encryption type, length, and so on. This way you can secure your presentations from others.



Protect your presentations with the new password protection option in Powerpoint XP

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